

PARALLELISM

What is parallelism ?

When a sentence consists of two or more concepts, expressions, ideas, etc. that are logically equal, then they should be **parallel** or similar i.e they all should be in the same grammatical structure. It means that the sentence with the similar or parallel structure is balanced. It is used to show that the two or more ideas, expressions, etc. are of the same importance.

In these types of sentences, words should be parallel or equal to word, independent clauses to independent clauses, phrases to phrases, verb to verb, noun to noun, etc.

Some Important Rules to apply for 'Parallelism' :-

(A) Parallelism of 'Words' :

- **Cricket, volleyball and football** are my favourite sports.
- He is **tall** and **handsome**.
- She went to **Mumbai and Delhi**.

(B) Parallelism of "Phrases" :

She likes **to swim, to hike and to ride a bicycle**.

I **wake up in the morning, go to the washroom, brush my teeth and take a bath**.

(C) Parallelism of 'Clauses' :

- The teacher told the students that **they should get** a healthy sleep, **they should meditate**, and **they should remain calm** on the day of exam. (In the highlighted parts the same pronoun and modal has been used)
- Aryan expected that **he would show** his presentation in the class and that **other students would ask** him questions.

(D) Parallelism of "Gerunds" :

- Mohit likes **reading books, playing video games and watching movies**. (In the highlighted parts the same structure of verbs (continuous form) and noun (Plural form) has been used.)
- She wants to go **hiking and trekking**.

(E) Parallelism in "Comparison" :

- His income **is greater than my sister's**. (Not 'My sister')
- **A brisk walk** is as beneficial to your health **as going for a run**. (Incorrect)
Going for a brisk walk is as beneficial to your health **as going for a run**. (Correct)

(F) Parallelism using "Correlative conjunctions" :

Correlative Conjunction is a paired conjunction that connects two equal parts of the sentence and shows the relationship between them. Some of the important correlative conjunctions are :-

- either...or
- not only...but also
- neither...nor
- whether...or
- rather...than
- both...and

Examples :-

- She is both **smart** and **intelligent**. (There is a positive adjective after 'both' & 'and')
- He is not only **an excellent** student but also **a great** learner. (There is a positive adjective after 'not only' & 'but also')
- We can neither **wait** for something to happen nor **take** evasive action. (In the highlighted parts, the first form of the verb has been used after 'neither' & 'nor')

(G) Parallelism using “ Coordinate Conjunctions” :

If we have coordinating conjunctions like- for, and, yet, but, not, or, etc. which are used to connect two main clauses then we have to make sure that the same grammatical structure is used on both the sides of the conjunction.

Examples :-

- She **likes to go** for a movie but her friend **prefers staying** at home. **(Incorrect)**
She **likes to go** for a movie but her friend **prefers to stay** at home. **(Correct)**
- The Company decided **to reduce** its workforce, **cut its** benefits and **lowering** workers' wages. **(Incorrect)**
The Company decided **to reduce** its workforce, **cut its** benefits and **lower** workers' wages. **(Correct)**

Practice Exercise**Spot the Error :-**

Directions :- In these questions, read each sentence to find out whether there is any error in it. The error, if any, will be in one part of the sentence. The number of that part is the answer, if there is no error the answer is (d). (Ignore errors of punctuation, if any.)

- Q.1.** (a) She is the happiest, /(b) the healthier, and the /(c) most fulfilled she has ever been /(d) no error.
- Q.2.** (a) They saved money, /(b) but they also /(c) spend it wisely /(d) no error.
- Q.3.** (a) He neither listens /(b) to music nor /(c) watched television /(d) no error.
- Q.4.** (a) Neither the beginning /(b) nor the end of the /(c) story was predictable /(d) no error.
- Q.5.** (a) The movie was as /(b) exciting as it was /(c) thought-provoked /(d) no error.
- Q.6.** (a) She is skilled at /(b) writing, edit, /(c) and proofreading /(d) no error.
- Q.7.** (a) The challenge is /(b) as daunted as /(c) it is rewarding /(d) no error.
- Q.8.** (a) Either we go out /(b) for dinner or /(c) we cook at home /(d) no error.
- Q.9.** (a) He bought apples, /(b) oranges, and bananas /(c) from the grocery store /(d) no error.
- Q.10.** (a) Not only does he /(b) play the piano, but he /(c) also sang beautifully /(d) no error.
- Q.11.** (a) We need to clean the kitchen, /(b) vacuumed the living /(c) room, and dust the shelves /(d) no error.
- Q.12.** (a) She can /(b) both sing /(c) and dance /(d) no error.
- Q.13.** (a) They traveled to Paris /(b) and then they explore the /(c) Louvre Museum /(d) no error.
- Q.14.** (a) The situation is /(b) getting worse, /(c) not best /(d) no error.
- Q.15.** (a) The journey was /(b) as enjoyable as /(c) it was adventure /(d) no error.

Answers With Explanation :-**Spot the Error**

- Sol.1.(b)** Replace “healthier” with “healthiest”. (Parallel Structure in case of Comparatives and Superlatives)
- Sol.2.(c)** Replace “spend” with “spent”. (Parallel Structure in Clauses)
- Sol.3.(c)** Replace “watched” with “watches”. (Parallel Structure in Paired Conjunctions- neither...nor)
- Sol.4.(d)** no error.

Sol.5.(c) Replace "provoked" with "provoking". (Parallel Structure in Comparisons)

Sol.6.(b) Replace "edit" with "editing". (Parallelism in gerunds)

Sol.7.(b) Replace "dauted" with "daunting". (Parallel Structure in Comparisons)

Sol.8.(d) no error.

Sol.9.(d) no error.

Sol.10.(c) Replace "sang" with "sings". (Parallel Structure in Correlative Conjunctions)

Sol.11.(b) Replace "vacuumed" with "vacuum". (Parallel Structure in phrases)

Sol.12.(d) no error.

Sol.13.(b) Replace "explore" with "explored". (Parallel Structure in Clauses)

Sol.14.(c) Replace "best" with "better". (Parallel Structure in Comparisons)

Sol.15.(c) Replace "adventure" with the adjective "adventurous" to match with the adjective 'enjoyable'. (Parallel Structure in Comparisons)